

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 170

By Roberts

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Elder James Richard Hilliard of Springfield.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Elder James Richard Hilliard; and

WHEREAS, Elder Hilliard was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Elder Hilliard served with acumen and alacrity as a line three operator for Delight Products for over thirty years, in which position he earned the respect of his peers and superiors alike for the exemplary quality of his work; and

WHEREAS, Elder James Hilliard was an active and devout pastor of the Calvary Temple, which he founded in 1998 after being saved at Bethel Apostolic Temple, under the leadership of Pastor Margaret S. Coutts; and

WHEREAS, Elder Hilliard pastored the Calvary Temple for over a decade and was ordained as a Pastor/Elder by Prophetic Miracle Ministries Worldwide (PMMW) Inc.; under the tutelage of Apostle Leo S. Lewis, Elder Hilliard remained with PMMW Churches until he returned to Springfield; and

WHEREAS, upon his return, Elder Hilliard joined City of Faith International under Pastor Robert A. Gardner, which he served for many years as a deacon, usher, van driver, and men's choir member; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Elder Hilliard always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Elder James Hilliard enjoyed the loving companionship of his wife, Clister Kay Hilliard, for forty-four years and was the proud father of Julius Fisher, Mexina Fisher, OrMonda (Derrick) Gregory, and Jessica (Bishop Leo Jr.) Lewis; grandfather of Montreal Fisher,

Ormondria Gardner, Martez Fisher, Keeonna Elliott, MaKayla Dowlen, Jazni Lewis, L'Oneal Lewis, and Leo Lewis III; and great-grandfather of Jeremiah Ambuehl, and Onaje' Esaw; and

WHEREAS, Elder Hilliard is further survived by his siblings, Deacon Winston (Evangelist Mira) Hilliard, Brother David Hilliard, Deacon Larry (LaTonya) Hilliard, Minister Mary E. Gardner, Minister Margie McKissick, and Lady-elect Elaine (Elder Samuel) Anderson; his brothers-in-law and sisters-in-law; adopted children, Jeff Thomas, Sr., Earl Johnson, Sherry Johnson, Elder Theresa Sampy, and Minister Elizabeth Ivey; special friends, Ralph Dotson, Sr., Mathis Vaughn, Lee Woodard, Deacon Sam M. Maitsi, Deacon Carlos Lynch, and Deacon David Elliott; and a host of nieces, nephews, cousins, and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Richard and Eunice Hilliard, Elder James Hilliard was preceded in death by his sister, Alice Fay Hilliard; and

WHEREAS, Elder James Hilliard leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Elder James Richard Hilliard, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Elder Hilliard.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.